

HEAT ILLNESS PREVENTION STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE (SOP)

For Commercial Exterior Cleaning Operations

1. PURPOSE

This Heat Illness Prevention SOP is designed to protect your company employees from heat-related illnesses and injuries during drone-powered, pressure washing, and soft wash operations. This policy aligns with OSHA's proposed Heat Injury and Illness Prevention Standard (Docket No. OSHA-2021-0009) and applies to all exterior job sites with a heat index at or above 80°F.

2. SCOPE

This SOP applies to all field staff performing exterior cleaning operations—including drone washing, roof washing, window cleaning, and traditional ground-based pressure washing—during elevated heat conditions at or above 80°F Heat Index.

3. RESPONSIBILITIES

- The Site Supervisor or Crew Lead shall serve as the Heat Safety Coordinator on each job.
- All employees must participate in daily heat briefings and follow required protocols.
- All new or returning workers must follow acclimatization protocols.

4. HEAT INDEX TRIGGER LEVELS

- 80°F+ → Initiate Basic Heat Protocol
- 90°F+ → Activate High Heat Protocol (more breaks, enhanced monitoring)
- Heat Index must be verified using the National Weather Service, OSHA Heat App, or equivalent.

5. DAILY PROTOCOLS

The following procedures must be completed on all job sites meeting or exceeding the heat index threshold:

- Conduct a pre-shift heat safety briefing
- Ensure 1 quart of drinking water per person per hour is available
- Provide a shaded rest area (tent, shaded trailer, or vehicle with A/C)
- Schedule mandatory rest breaks:
 - Every 2 hours for 80–89°F
 - Every 1 hour for 90°F and above
- Monitor new workers more frequently
- Observe for signs of heat stress (confusion, dizziness, cramps, vomiting)

6. TRAINING REQUIREMENTS

your company employees shall receive heat illness prevention training at hiring and annually. Topics include:

- Recognizing heat stress symptoms
- Proper hydration and rest cycles
- Emergency response procedures
- Use of the Heat Index chart

7. EMERGENCY RESPONSE

- All crews must know the location of the nearest urgent care or hospital.
- Any signs of heat stroke must trigger immediate 911 call.
- Cool the affected individual with shade, misting fans, or cold packs until help arrives.
- Document and report all heat-related incidents to designated safety officer within 24 hours.

8. ACCLIMATIZATION PLAN

New hires and returning workers (after >7 days away) must follow a 4-day gradual exposure plan:

- Day 1: 25% of typical workload
- Day 2: 50%
- Day 3: 75%
- Day 4: 100% with continued monitoring

9. REVIEW AND RECORDKEEPING

- This SOP shall be reviewed annually or after any heat-related incident.
- Daily job logs must include heat index, water/rest records, and incidents.
- Keep records on file for 2 years minimum.

DISCLAIMER FOR RESELLABLE USE

This document was developed for your company operations and is compliant with proposed OSHA Heat Illness Prevention regulations as of 2026. It is provided as a general-use SOP template for commercial cleaning operators. Users should consult legal or safety professionals to adapt this SOP to their own jurisdiction or company policies.